

Every problem has a solution

Data loss? A slow computer? You've come to the right place...

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Dynamic disk a disaster?

I recently purchased a Dell laptop (configuration – Intel Core 2 Duo P8700, 4 GB RAM, 500 GB HDD). The laptop came with a single partition and loaded with Windows 7 Home Premium edition. I used the disk management utility for partitioning the disk. I created four partitions (150, 100, 100, 100 GB), but in the process my hard disk has changed into dynamic type from the basic type. I have the following queries: - what is a dynamic type hard disk? What differences are there between a dynamic and the basic type? How can I change the drive back to basic?

I have tried all possible options including - disk manage-

ment, partition magic software, etc but I am not able to convert the disk back to basic type. By right clicking the complete disk, I do not get the option to convert the same to basic type.

Sanjay Mehta

The main difference between a basic and a dynamic disk is the way data is stored. Dynamic disk allows creation of volumes that can be spread over multiple drives where as a basic disk will not let you do so. For most practical purposes, it doesn't really matter to most of us. The only problem is that once you have a dynamic disk created, you cannot convert it back to a basic disk unless you delete all the partitions and convert the drive to a basic one. Basic disks were used till Windows 2000 was released. Most Windows operating systems, with a few exceptions since then, use dynamic disks for storage.

Slow Windows file copy

I use Windows XP SP2. My file copy and move operations are really slow. Please give me sug-

gest some copy handler software. Thanks and keep it up.

Manish Bhuva

Check out a software called Teracopy (www.codesector.com/teracopy.php). It's free and available for download. It lets you copy files, verify them and also shows you the speed. The performance of file copy in your system might be affected due to badly fragmented data on the drive.

Motherboard change affects DVDs?

I upgraded my Intel Pentium 4 motherboard with an AMD 790GX motherboard and an AMD Athlon X2 processor. Everything works fine, except my DVD writer. It does not recognise the DVDs burned with my earlier motherboard, but Digit DVDs run fine. Please help. Also, I need to know if I can run Windows XP 32-bit in Virtualbox inside Windows 7 64-bit.

Tatai Banik

The DVD reading problem might not have to do with the motherboard but with the drive itself. DVD drives start giving problems very often. Try the same drive on a different system and see if it works. Do the same with the DVDs you burnt on the old motherboard. Windows 7 64-bit should run a 32-bit Windows XP just fine within Virtualbox.

How to recover data from Seagate 80GB drive

My four-year old Seagate 80 GB hard disk is not working and

while booting, I am getting a message 'Boot disk error. Enter CD to boot'. The motherboard BIOS is not even showing any hard disk connected. I've checked all the wires and connections and seems like the problem is with the drive.

Is there any way to recover all the data and if so can you tell me any support centre. I live in Trivandrum. I can go to Bangalore too if you know about any genuine support there.

Karthik J

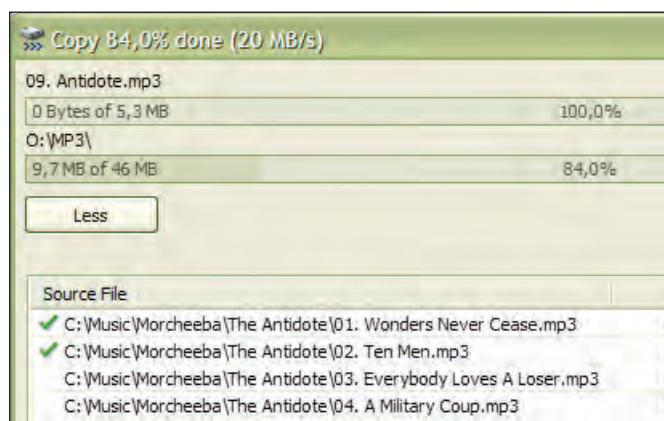
You can take your hard drive to Stellar Data Recovery at their Bangalore office. Contact details can be found on their site www.stellarinfo.com/contact/. Keep in mind that data recovery can cost a lot depending on the state of the drive and the capacity of data to be recovered

CRT monitor losing control

I have an IBM monitor-E74(CRT). For the last few days, the monitor automatically changes its brightness, contrast etc. and I am unable to control it. It is causing me a lot of problems and I would be really grateful if you can help.

Bishwadeep

There are obviously some serious problems with the CRT monitor that can't be fixed by changing settings on it or through the PC. You need to take it to a service centre to get it repaired. It might be something to do with the front control panel. We also recommend opting for an LCD screen.



Teracopy is a great third party file copy utility